Project Report

On

Travel Together - A Web Platform for Solo Travellers

in

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

B. Tech. - VII Semester

Submitted by

1. Hrutuja Umratkar 2. Aman Yadav

3. Chandan Kumar 4. Prakash Wagh

Under the guidance of

Prof. Y. D. Choudhari

K. D. K. COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING,

Nagpur - 440024

2025-2026

Declaration

This Project work entitled **Travel Together - A Web Platform for Solo Travellers** is our own carried out under the supervision of **Prof**. **Y. D. Choudhari** & **Prof. P. S. Dewalkar** at Department of Information Technology, K D K College of Engineering, Nagpur. It is ensured that proper citation of references is done.

As far as our knowledge is concern, this work has not been submitted to any other university for the award of any degree.

Sr. No.	Name of Projectee	Roll No.	Sign
1	Hrutuja Umratkar	11	
2	Aman Yadav	41	
3	Prakash Wagh	53	
4	Chandan Kumar	48	

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Projectee

Hrutuja Umratkar

Aman Yadav

Chandan Kumar

Prakash Wagh

K. D. K. College of Engineering, Nagpur

Department of Information Technology

Session - 2025-2026

Certificate

This is to certify that the Project work entitled **Travel Together - A Web Platform for Solo Travellers** is submitted by the following students of VII Semester B. Tech. Information Technology.

1. Hrutuja Umratkar
2. Aman Yadav
3. Chandan Kumar
4. Prakash Wagh

is a bonafied work done under my/our supervision. This project work is submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirement for the award of Degree of Bachelor of Information Technology under the Faculty of Science & Technology; RTM Nagpur University, Nagpur during the Academic Year 2025 –2026.

Guide
Prof. Y. D. Choudhari
Assistant Professor

Co-Guide
Prof. P. S. Dewalkar
Assistant Professor

Dr. Mrs. S. P. Khandait
Professor & Head, IT,
K. D. K. College of Engineering, Nagpur

Dr. Valsson Varghese
Principal
K. D. K. College of Engineering, Nagpur

External Examiner

Abstract

In the age of digital connectivity, travellers increasingly seek companions who share similar itineraries, interests, and safety concerns. Buddy finder systems aim to connect travellers based on mutual preferences, enabling shared experiences and reducing the risks associated with solo travel. However, many existing platforms provide limited personalization and insufficient trust mechanisms.

This project presents **"Travel Together – A Web Platform for Solo Travellers,"** an intelligent and secure system designed to enhance the solo travel experience. The platform uses a compatibility-based matching algorithm that evaluates user preferences such as budget, travel style, planning approach, and travel frequency to generate personalized buddy recommendations. The system follows a scalable three-tier architecture and adopts the Model-View-Controller (MVC) framework for modular development.

In addition to intelligent matching, the platform integrates secure authentication, profile verification, real-time communication, and a trust-based rating mechanism to improve user safety and engagement. The study also reviews existing travel companion platforms to identify challenges such as cold-start issues and security concerns. The proposed solution demonstrates how combining personalization, security, and social interaction features can create a reliable and scalable travel companion system. Future enhancements may include AI-driven personalization and advanced identity verification mechanisms.

Key Words: -

Travel Companion, Trip Matching, Solo Travel, Traveler Profiles, Travel Interests, Destination-Based Matching, Adventure Planning Mobile Application, Travel planning.

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CHAPTER 1:

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Overview

In recent years, solo travel has gained remarkable popularity among individuals seeking freedom, flexibility, and self-discovery. It allows travellers to explore destinations at their own pace, make independent choices, and embrace cultural experiences without external constraints. Despite its growing appeal, solo travel often presents several challenges, including feelings of loneliness, safety concerns, higher travel expenses, and the burden of managing logistics independently. These issues can diminish the overall travel experience, especially for those venturing into unfamiliar regions.

With the rapid advancement of mobile and web-based technologies, innovative digital solutions have been developed to overcome such limitations. Among these, travel buddy finder systems have emerged as an effective and social approach to enhancing the travel experience. These systems enable travelers to find companions with similar destinations, travel dates, or interests, thereby promoting companionship, cultural exchange, and cost-sharing. Furthermore, by fostering mutual support and interaction, such platforms contribute to a safer and more enjoyable travel environment.

In this context, the proposed system titled "Travel Together" introduces a comprehensive travel companion matching platform that integrates multiple smart features into a single application. Unlike traditional platforms that primarily focus on user matching or chat functions, *Travel Together* employs AI-driven algorithms to recommend compatible travel partners based on interest profiles, destinations, and behavioural data. It also incorporates real-time location tracking, profile verification mechanisms, and user feedback systems to enhance trust, safety, and reliability within the community.

This review examines the functionality and limitations of existing travel buddy systems, identifying opportunities for innovation in terms of user experience, safety, and intelligent matchmaking. The ultimate goal of the *Travel Together* concept is to design a secure, interactive, and user-friendly platform that not only facilitates meaningful travel connections but also ensures an enriching, affordable, and safe journey for all users.

1.2 Aim

The aim of the Travel Together – A Buddy Finder System is to develop an intelligent and secure web-based platform that helps travelers find compatible travel companions based on their destination, travel dates, and interests. The system seeks to enhance the solo travel experience by promoting social connections, ensuring safety through verified profiles, and simplifying trip coordination through communication and itinerary-sharing features.

1.3 Objective

The main objective of the **Travel Together** project is to design and develop an intelligent and secure **Web Platform** that connects travelers with similar destinations, interests, and travel periods. The system aims to enhance the solo travel experience through meaningful companionship, cost-sharing, and safety features.

Specific Objectives:

1. **To develop a user-friendly web and mobile application** that allows travelers to register, create detailed profiles, and specify their travel preferences such as destinations, dates, and interests.
2. **To implement an intelligent matching algorithm** that recommends suitable travel companions based on user preferences, trip details, and compatibility scores.
3. **To integrate real-time communication and location tracking features** enabling users to chat, plan, and coordinate their journeys securely.
4. **To enhance user trust and safety** by incorporating verified user profiles, ratings, and review systems for transparent and reliable interactions.
5. **To provide trip management tools** such as itinerary sharing, group formation, and expense-splitting options to simplify collaborative travel planning.
6. **To ensure data privacy and security** through proper authentication mechanisms and encrypted data exchange.

1.4 Methodology

The methodology for developing **Travel Together – A Buddy Finder System** is designed to systematically plan, analyze, design, implement, and test the system. The approach combines both theoretical research and practical implementation to ensure that the final system is efficient, reliable, and user-friendly. The methodology is divided into the following key phases.

Requirement Analysis

The first step is to identify and analyze the requirements of the proposed system. This involves understanding the problems faced by solo travelers and reviewing existing buddy finder platforms. The major requirements are categorized as follows.

1. **Functional Requirements**

- User Registration and Authentication
- Profile Creation with travel interests, destinations, and dates
- Search and Matching of potential buddies based on preferences
- Messaging/Chat system for communication
- Safety and Trust features (profile verification, feedback, and rating system)

2. **Non-Functional Requirements**

- Security of personal data and travel information
- Scalability to support many users
- Reliability with minimal downtime
- User-friendly interface for smooth navigation

Requirement gathering is done through **literature review, surveys, and observation of existing apps** to ensure that the system is relevant and practical.

System Design

In this phase, the system architecture and workflow are designed. The design is structured into three main layers:

1. **Frontend**
   The frontend will be developed using **HTML, CSS, and JavaScript** with responsive design for both web and mobile devices. The interface will allow easy profile setup, travel buddy search, and interaction.
2. **Backend**
   The backend will handle data storage, matching algorithms, and communication. Technologies like **Node.js with Express.js** can be used. MongoDB databases will store user profiles, travel details, and communication logs.
3. **Database**
   - User Table (personal details, login credentials)
   - Travel Details Table (destination, date, interests)
   - Buddy Match Table (suggested matches, status)
   - Messaging Table (chat history)
   - Reviews/Rating Table (feedback system)
4. **System Workflow**
   - User registers and creates a travel profile.
   - System suggests matches based on destination, travel dates, and interests.
   - User can connect with suggested buddies through in-app chat.
   - Location tracking is enabled during travel (optional).
   - Feedback and ratings are provided after the trip to build trust.

Development Methodology

For the implementation, an **Agile Model** will be adopted. Agile is chosen because it allows flexibility, iterative development, and quick response to changes. The process will be divided into **sprints**, each focusing on specific modules:

- **Sprint 1:** User registration and login system
- **Sprint 2:** Profile creation and travel detail management
- **Sprint 3:** Matching algorithm and search functionality
- **Sprint 4:** Chat and communication module
- **Sprint 5:** Location tracking and safety features
- **Sprint 6:** Testing, debugging, and deployment

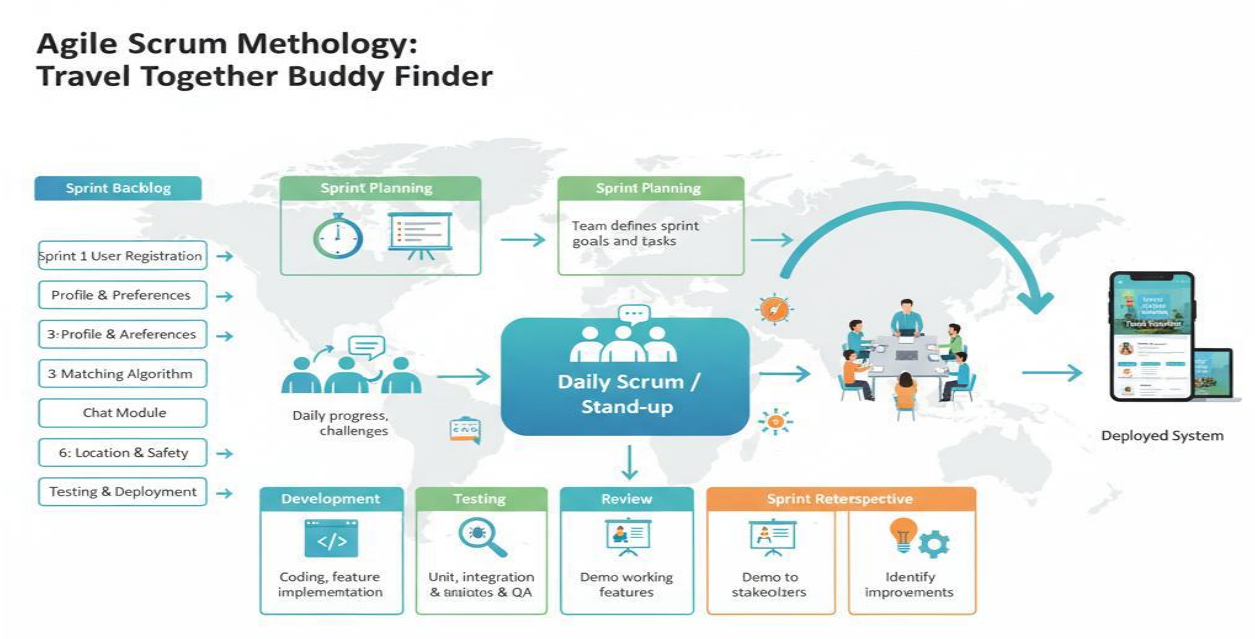

Fig. 1.41 Development Methodology

Each sprint will include planning, development, testing, and review, ensuring continuous improvement throughout the project lifecycle.

Matching Algorithm

The core of the system is the matching algorithm, which connects travelers with similar plans. The algorithm will consider multiple factors:

- Destination and Travel Dates: Highest priority for compatibility.
- Interests and Preferences: Medium priority to improve experience.
- Trust Factor: Based on reviews and verification.

For example, if two users are traveling to Goa during the same week and both are interested in adventure sports, the system will rank them higher as potential buddies

Implementation Tools and Technologies

- **Frontend:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript , React.js
- **Backend:** Node.js with Express.js
- **Database**: MongoDB
- **Authentication:** Firebase Authentication

Deployment and Maintenance

Once testing is complete, the system will be deployed on a cloud server for public use. Maintenance will include fixing bugs, upgrading security, and adding new features as per user feedback. Regular updates will ensure the system remains relevant and effective for travelers.

CHAPTER 2:

LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Background Study

The rapid growth of digital technologies and mobile internet usage has significantly transformed the travel industry. With the increasing popularity of solo travel, travelers are seeking platforms that can connect them with like-minded companions to enhance safety, reduce travel costs, and improve overall experience. Traditional travel planning platforms primarily focus on booking services such as transportation and accommodation, but they often lack intelligent mechanisms to facilitate social connectivity among travelers.

Travel companion and recommendation systems have emerged as an important research area within recommender systems and social networking domains. These systems aim to match users based on common destinations, travel dates, interests, behavioral patterns, and trust factors. Early systems relied on rule-based and content-based matching approaches, where recommendations were generated using predefined criteria such as destination similarity or shared preferences.

With the advancement of machine learning and artificial intelligence, modern travel companion platforms have incorporated collaborative filtering, hybrid recommendation models, and knowledge graph-based techniques to enhance matching accuracy. These intelligent models analyze user behavior, historical travel data, and contextual information to provide more personalized suggestions. Additionally, time-aware and location-based recommendation systems have improved contextual relevance by considering factors such as travel season, GPS location, and real-time activity data.

Alongside personalization, trust and safety mechanisms have become critical components of travel buddy platforms. Since users interact with strangers, features such as identity verification, review systems, moderation, and encrypted communication are essential for ensuring user confidence and long-term adoption. Researchers have highlighted that safety perception directly influences user engagement and retention in online travel companionship systems.

Despite these advancements, several challenges remain. Cold-start problems, scalability issues, computational complexity of advanced models, privacy concerns, and data sparsity continue to affect system performance. Moreover, balancing personalization with user data protection is a major concern in modern travel platforms.

Therefore, the proposed system “Travel Together” aims to integrate intelligent matching algorithms with strong safety mechanisms and user-friendly design. By combining AI-driven personalization, secure authentication, and real-time interaction features, the system attempts to address the limitations identified in existing literature and provide a comprehensive travel companion solution.

2.2 Literature Review

The development of travel companion and recommendation systems has seen steady progress in matching algorithms, personalization, trust/safety mechanisms, and real-time/contextual recommendations. The following works lay out how the field has evolved, what has been achieved, and what gaps remain — which this study intends to address.

1. R. Das, N. Natarajan, and K. S. Murthy (2024) developed **Travel Tinder**, a platform for matching solo travelers using a hybrid recommendation system. Their approach combines several criteria—interest similarity, safety, preferences—to produce buddy matches. They showed enhanced user satisfaction and better matching quality, though the system's scalability and cold-start when few user profiles exist remain limitations.[1]
2. A.Khan and M. Roy (2023) introduced a system using **Knowledge Graph Attention Network (KGAT)** for personalized travel buddy and destination recommendations. Their work demonstrates strong accuracy by modeling relationships among users, destinations, and travel behaviours, but points out computational costs and latency challenges, especially on resource-constrained devices or with large datasets. [2]
3. M. Banerjee and S. Mitra (2022) proposed **GuideMe**, which integrates collaborative filtering with social blog data. This offers richer contextual recommendations by bringing in user-generated content (reviews, blogs) to refine suggestions. However, extracting reliable signals from noisy or biased unstructured social content remains a challenge. [3]
4. S. A. Rajan and R. S. Mehta (2023) explored **time-aware recommender systems** for e-tourism. By incorporating temporal context (time of travel, season, etc.), they achieved more relevant suggestions. But issues such as incomplete user travel history, or sparsity of timestamped data, reduce the effectiveness for new users or irregular travelers. [4]
5. H. Nakamura, K. Tanaka, and R. Yamamoto (2022) implemented **real-time, location-based services** in a mobile tourist guide app that offers suggestions based on a user's current GPS location. The advantage lies in spontaneity and immediacy of suggestions (places to visit, buddies nearby, etc.), but this depends heavily on connectivity, battery, and raises privacy concerns. [5]
6. Weiser & Brown (2020) examined how **social networking** supports travel companionship: how communities and online platforms facilitate meeting travel buddies; what design best practices help build trust, engagement, and long-term usage. Their work points out that travel platforms must carefully manage features around trust, profile verification, and user interaction to maintain safety and retention. [6]
7. Gonzalez & Johnson (2019) traced the **evolution of travel buddy platforms** from early community/couchsurfing models to modern mobile applications. They emphasize how shifts in user expectations (mobile UI, instant matching, reviews) and technology (smartphones, cloud services) have redefined what users expect from travel companion networks. [7]
8. Singh & Sharma (2018) surveyed matching algorithms in **travel companion finders**: rule-based, content-based, collaborative filtering, hybrid models. They analyze trade-

offs in matching accuracy vs computational cost, especially under sparse data or varied user preferences. [8]

9. Huang & Lee (2017) designed and evaluated a **travel buddy recommender system** based on personal preferences, travel behaviours, and ratings. Their user studies showed improvements in satisfaction when recommendations aligned with user's past travel style. But demographic diversity and cold-start issues (when user has little or no history) were problematic. [9]
10. Patel & Goyal (2021) focused on **ensuring user safety** in online travel platforms: trust and verification mechanisms such as identity verification, peer reviews, moderation. They argue that safety is often as important as matching accuracy for user adoption. [10]
11. Zhou & Zhang (2020) studied **security challenges**: fraudulent accounts, privacy violations, malicious users; and best practices to mitigate these via secure design, clear policies, verification, encryption. They also point out that even well-designed systems can struggle to enforce trust when users have limited willingness to share personal data. [11]

2.3 Summary/Findings of Literature Review

Based on the review of existing research works on travel companion and recommendation systems, the following key findings have been observed:

Sr. No.	Author & Year	Approach Used	Key Contribution	Limitations Identified
1	R. Das et al. (2024)	Hybrid Recommendation System	Improved buddy matching using interest + safety criteria	Cold-start problem, scalability issues
2	Khan & Roy (2023)	Knowledge Graph Attention Network (KGAT)	Highly personalized recommendations	High computational cost, latency issues
3	Banerjee & Mitra (2022)	Collaborative Filtering + Social Blogs	Context-rich recommendations	Noisy/unstructured social data
4	Rajan & Mehta (2023)	Time-Aware Recommender	Context-based seasonal suggestions	Sparse or incomplete user history
5	Nakamura et al. (2022)	Real-time Location-Based Services	GPS-based dynamic suggestions	Privacy concerns, connectivity dependency

6	Weiser & Brown (2020)	Social Networking Analysis	Emphasis on trust & engagement	Limited technical implementation details
7	Gonzalez & Johnson (2019)	Evolutionary Study	Shift to mobile-first platforms	General study, not algorithm-focused
8	Singh & Sharma (2018)	Survey of Matching Algorithms	Comparison of rule-based, content & hybrid models	Trade-off between accuracy & cost
9	Huang & Lee (2017)	Preference-Based Recommender	Improved user satisfaction	Cold-start & demographic diversity issues
10	Patel & Goyal (2021)	Trust & Verification Mechanisms	Identity verification & safety measures	Balancing privacy & usability
11	Zhou & Zhang (2020)	Security Framework Analysis	Identified fraud & privacy risks	User reluctance in sharing data

Table 2.3.1 Findings of Literature Review

CHAPTER 3:

PROPOSED WORK

3.1 Introduction

The proposed system titled "Travel Together – A Web Platform for Solo Travelers" is designed to provide an intelligent and secure digital platform that connects solo travelers based on compatibility, preferences, and trust factors. The system aims to overcome the limitations identified in existing travel companion platforms, such as lack of personalization, security concerns, and insufficient integration of social features.

The proposed work focuses on developing a full-stack web application that integrates buddy matching, real-time communication, social interaction, and profile verification within a single unified system.

3.2 System Architecture

The proposed system follows a three-tier architecture consisting of the Presentation Layer, Application Layer, and Data Layer.

The Presentation Layer (Frontend) is responsible for user interaction. It provides interfaces for user registration, login, profile management, buddy search, chat, and social feed. This layer is developed using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and EJS templates to ensure dynamic and responsive web pages.

The Application Layer (Backend) manages business logic, compatibility calculation, routing, authentication, and session management. It is implemented using Node.js and Express.js framework. The system follows the Model-View-Controller (MVC) pattern to maintain modularity and separation of concerns.

The Data Layer (Database) is implemented using MongoDB, with Mongoose ORM used for schema definition and data modeling. It stores user profiles, travel preferences, chat conversations, messages, reviews, and feed posts.

This architectural approach ensures scalability, flexibility, and maintainability of the system.

3.3 Working of the Proposed System

The working of the system begins with user registration and authentication. Users create an account by providing personal details and travel preferences such as budget, travel type, planning style, and travel frequency.

After successful registration, the system activates the matching module. The compatibility between users is calculated using a weighted scoring mechanism based on preference

similarity. Users with higher compatibility percentages are ranked at the top of the buddy suggestion list.

Once matched, users can initiate real-time communication through the chat module. The chat system enables secure and encrypted messaging to ensure safe interaction.

In addition to matching and chat features, users can share travel experiences, images, and posts through the social feed module. This enhances community engagement and builds trust among users.

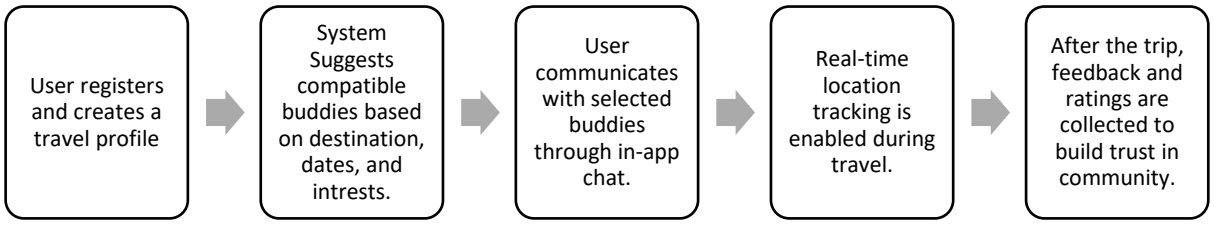

Fig 3.3.1 System Workflow

3.4 Intelligent Matching Mechanism

The core of the proposed system is the compatibility-based matching algorithm. The algorithm evaluates similarity between users using weighted parameters:

- Budget Preference – 35%
- Planning Style – 30%
- Travel Type – 25%
- Travel Frequency – 10%

Verified users receive additional weight to promote trust and reliability within the platform.

The compatibility percentage is calculated using the formula:

Compatibility Score = (Match Score / Maximum Score) × 100

Users are ranked in descending order based on their compatibility percentage, ensuring accurate and personalized buddy recommendations.

3.5 Database Design

The database is structured into multiple collections to support system functionality:

- The User collection stores personal details, travel preferences, verification status, and review information.
- The Conversation collection manages chat sessions between users.

- The Message collection stores encrypted communication records along with timestamps.
- The Feed collection stores user-generated posts, images, likes, and comments.
- The schema design ensures efficient data retrieval, scalability, and integrity.

3.6 Security Implementation

Security is an essential component of the proposed system. Passwords are securely hashed using bcrypt before being stored in the database. Session-based authentication is implemented to ensure controlled access to protected routes.

To prevent malicious activities, rate limiting mechanisms are applied to restrict excessive requests. Cross-site scripting (XSS) protection and input validation are implemented to safeguard against injection attacks. The real-time chat feature supports encrypted communication, and uploaded files are validated before being stored in secure cloud storage.

These security mechanisms ensure data privacy, reliability, and user trust.

CHAPTER 4:

RESULT & CONCLUSION

4.1 Result

This section presents the final visual output of the "Travel Together" web application. The following screenshots display the key user interfaces, including the landing page, the home dashboard, and the user verification center. A primary result is the dynamic community feed, which successfully renders user-generated posts and images directly from the MongoDB database. The AI-integrated "Create Post" form is also shown, demonstrating the successful implementation of all core project objectives. This culminates in a functional and modern platform for solo.

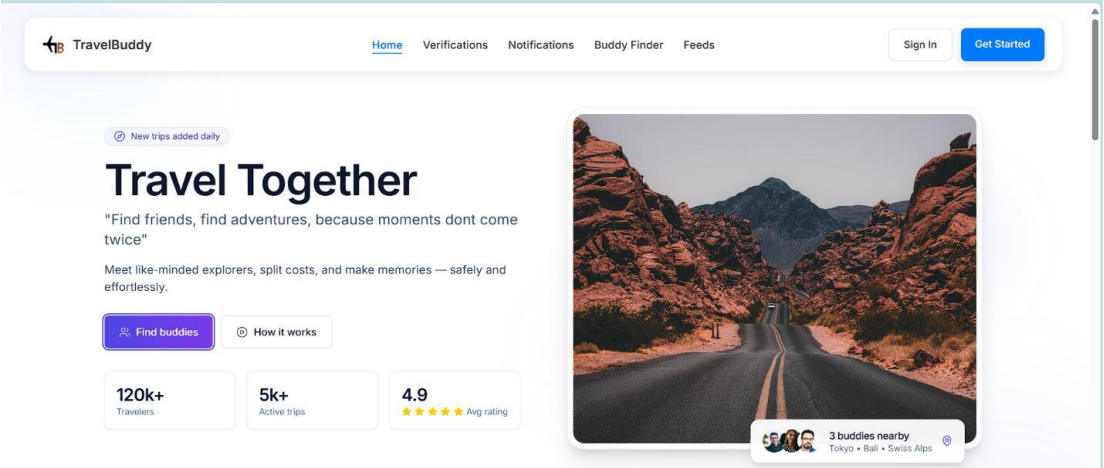

Fig 4.1.1 Home page

- The Home Page of the Travel Together application serves as the main entry point of the system. It includes a navigation bar, buddy finder option, and key statistics such as active trips and user ratings.

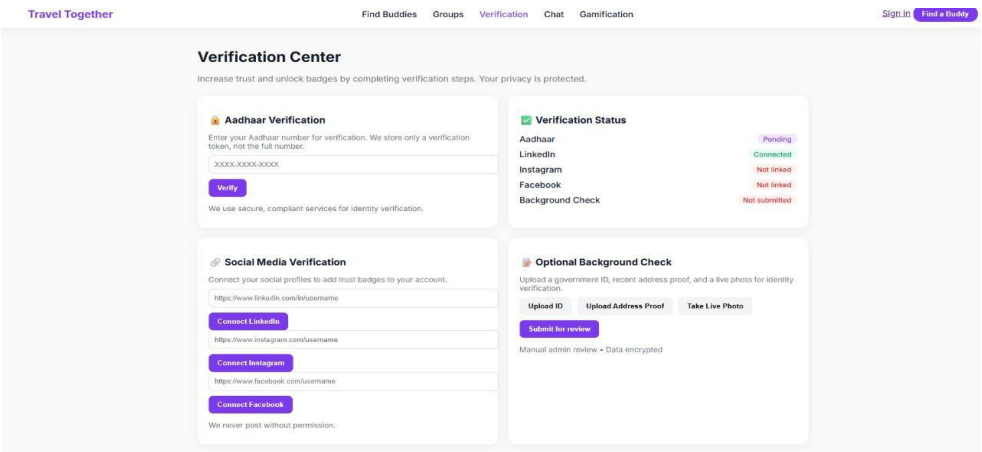

Fig 4.1.2 Verification Center Page

- The Verification Center page allows users to verify their identity through Aadhaar, social media accounts, and optional background checks.

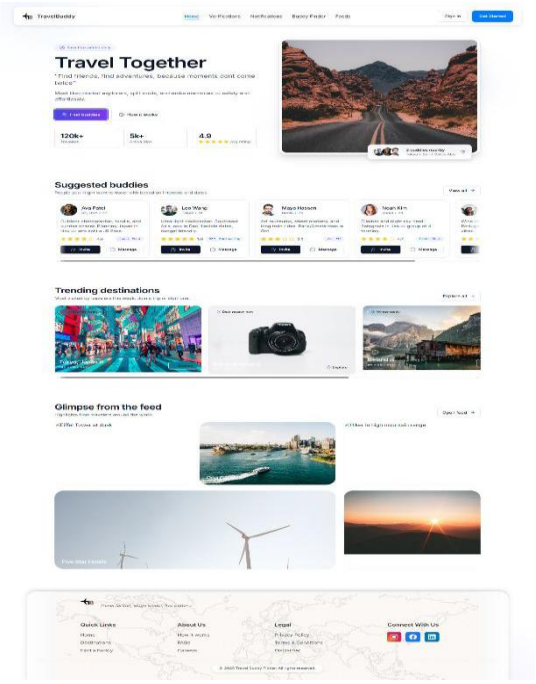

Fig 4.1.3 Feed Page

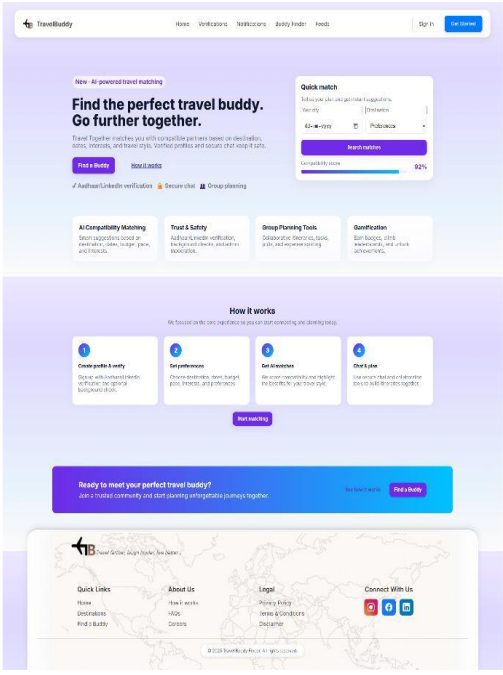

Fig 4.1.4 Landing Page

- The Feed Page displays travel-related posts, suggested buddies, and trending destinations to enhance user engagement.
- The Landing Page introduces the Travel Together platform and highlights its core purpose of helping users find compatible travel buddies.

4.2 Future Scope

The proposed Travel Together – A Buddy Finder System can be further enhanced in the future through the following advancements:

1. AI-Based Travel Partner Recommendations:
   Implement artificial intelligence and machine learning algorithms to analyze user preferences, behavior, and travel history for more accurate and personalized buddy matching.

2. GPS Integration for Real-Time Tracking:
   Integrate GPS technology to allow real-time location sharing and tracking during trips, improving safety and coordination among travel companions.

3. Mobile Application for iOS and Android:
   Develop dedicated mobile apps to provide users with a more convenient and accessible travel companion experience on the go.

4. In-App Group Chat and Secure Payment Options:
   Introduce in-app group communication features and secure payment gateways for expense sharing, booking coordination, and seamless trip management.

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Annexure I

Research Paper Publication

As part of our major project titled **"Travel Together – A Web Platform for Solo Travellers"**, we have published a research paper in the *International Journal for Research Publication and Seminar (IJRPS)* under the Special Edition: SPARK 2025 – XXI National Conference on Emerging Technology Trends in Engineering & Project Competition.

The paper presents the design and implementation of a web-based travel companion platform that uses a compatibility-based matching algorithm to connect solo travelers. It highlights system architecture, secure authentication, real-time chat integration, and trust-based features such as profile verification and ratings.

Full Research Paper Link: https://www.doi.org/10.56726/IRJMETS84011

The first page of the published research paper is attached below for reference.

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TRAVEL TOGETHER - A WEB PLATFORM FOR SOLO TRAVELERS

Aman S. Yadav*1, Hrutuja S. Umratkar*2, Chandan Kumar*3, Prakash B. Wagh*4

*1,2,3,4Information Technology KDK College Of Engineering Nagpur, India.

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ABSTRACT

The Travel Together web platform is designed to redefine the solo travel experience by connecting individuals with like-minded companions who share similar destinations, travel dates, and interests. Recognizing the growing popularity of solo travel—and its accompanying challenges such as loneliness, safety concerns, and higher expenses—this system offers a smart solution that enhances connectivity, safety, and affordability. The platform incorporates intelligent matching algorithms, real-time location tracking, verified user profiles, and feedback-based trust mechanisms to ensure reliable and secure interactions. By combining these innovative features, Travel Together not only promotes cultural exchange and shared experiences but also provides a user-friendly and dependable environment for travelers worldwide. The study reviews existing travel buddy systems, identifies their limitations, and demonstrates how Travel Together overcomes these challenges through technology-driven enhancements for safer and more meaningful journeys.

Keywords: Travel Together, Solo Travel, Travel Buddy Finder, Matching Algorithm, Real-Time Tracking, Verified Profiles, Safety, Web Platform.

I. INTRODUCTION

In recent years, solo travel has become very popular among people who wish to experience freedom, flexibility, and self-discovery. Travelling alone gives individuals the chance to make their own choices, explore new places at their own pace, and enjoy independence without depending on others. However, solo travel also comes with certain challenges such as loneliness, safety concerns, higher expenses, and the difficulty of managing travel plans alone. These issues sometimes make people hesitate to travel by themselves, even if they have a strong desire to explore.

With the growth of mobile and web technologies, many new ideas have been developed to help travellers overcome these problems. One such idea is the travel buddy finder system, which helps connect travelers who have similar destinations, travel dates, or interests. These systems allow people to find suitable companions for their trips, making travel more enjoyable and safer. They also help reduce costs by allowing travelers to share expenses and promote cultural exchange through meeting new people.

In this background, Travel Together is introduced as a new and improved web platform for solo travelers. Unlike other existing applications, it brings many useful features together in one system. It includes intelligent matching algorithms to connect travelers with similar interests, real-time location tracking for safety, verified profiles, and feedback systems to build trust among users.

The main aim of this research is to study existing travel companion systems, find their limitations, and propose better solutions that make solo travel more secure, reliable, and friendly. The Travel Together platform hopes to build a community where travelers can connect easily, share experiences, and make their journeys more meaningful and memorable.

II. RELATED WORK

The development of travel companion and recommendation systems has progressed steadily over the past decade, with major improvements in matching algorithms, personalization, safety mechanisms, and contextual recommendations. Various researchers have explored how intelligent technologies can help travelers find suitable companions and enjoy safer, more engaging journeys. The following studies highlight the key advancements, their limitations, and the gaps that motivate the development of the Travel Together platform.

R. Das, N. Natarajan, and K. S. Murthy (2024) introduced **Travel Tinder**, a hybrid recommendation platform designed to match solo travelers based on shared interests, preferences, and safety priorities. Their approach

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Review Paper Publication

We have also published a review paper based on our major project in IJRPS under SPARK 2025. The review paper analyzes existing travel companion systems, recommendation algorithms, and security mechanisms used in online travel platforms.

It identifies research gaps related to personalization, scalability, and user safety, and provides insights that guided the development of the proposed Travel Together platform.

Full Research Paper Link: https://www.doi.org/10.55041/ISJEM05243

The first page of the published review paper is attached below for reference.

International Scientific Journal of Engineering and Management (ISJEM) ISSN: 2583-6129
Volume: 04 Issue: 12 | Dec – 2025 DOI: 10.55041/ISJEM05243
An International Scholarly || Multidisciplinary || Open Access || Indexing in all major Database & Metadata

A Review of Modern Travel Buddy Finder Technology for Solo Travellers

Ass prof. Yogeshri Choudhari
Information Technology
KDK College of Engineering
Nagpur, India
Yogeshri.choudhari@kdkce.edu.in

Aman S. Yadav
Information Technology
KDK College of Engineering
Nagpur, India
amansyadav309@gamil.com

Hrutuja S. Umratkar
Information Technology
KDK College of Engineering
Nagpur, India
hrutujaumratkar123@gmail.com

Chandan Kumar
Information Technology
KDK College of Engineering
Nagpur, India
ck202045@gmail.com

Prakash B. Wagh
Information Technology
KDK College of Engineering
Nagpur, India
bhatuwagh177@gmail.com

Abstract - The rise of solo tourism has created a demand for digital solutions that address loneliness, safety, and cost. This paper presents a comprehensive review of existing travel companion platforms and recommendation systems, analyzing their matching algorithms, security protocols, and user engagement strategies. We examine the limitations of current technologies, such as the "cold-start" problem in recommendation engines and data privacy concerns in location-based services. Based on this literature review, we propose the conceptual architecture for "Travel Together," a comprehensive web platform designed to bridge existing gaps. The proposed framework integrates intelligent matching algorithms, real-time tracking, and verified trust mechanisms to create a safer and more reliable environment for global travellers.

Keywords: Solo Travel, Literature Review, Travel Buddy Finder, Recommender Systems, Web Architecture, Trust Mechanisms.

I. Introduction

Solo travel has gained popularity due to the freedom and flexibility it offers, allowing individuals to explore at their own pace. However, it presents significant challenges, including loneliness, safety concerns, higher costs, and logistical difficulties, which often deter potential travellers. To address these issues, mobile and web technologies have evolved to create "travel buddy finder systems". These platforms facilitate safer and more enjoyable trips by connecting travellers with similar itineraries, allowing for shared expenses and cultural exchange.

This paper introduces "Travel Together," a web platform designed to overcome the limitations of existing applications by integrating multiple features into a single system. Key features include intelligent matching algorithms, real-time location tracking, verified user profiles, and a feedback-based trust system.

The primary goal of this study is to review existing travel companion systems, identify their shortcomings, and propose "Travel Together" as a comprehensive solution to make solo travel more secure, reliable, and friendly.

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Annexure II

Plagiarism Report

This is to certify that the project report titled "Travel Together – A Web Platform for Solo Travellers" has been checked for plagiarism using authorized *searchenginereports.net* plagiarism detection software.

PLAGIARISM SCAN REPORT

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Characters: 38600
Excluded URL : N/A

4% Plagiarism	96% Unique
11 Plagiarized Sentences (4% of 275)	264 Unique Sentences (96% of 275)

Content Checked for Plagiarism

1.1 Overview

In recent years, solo travel has gained remarkable popularity among individuals seeking freedom, flexibility, and self-discovery. It allows travellers to explore destinations at their own pace, make independent choices, and embrace cultural experiences without external constraints. Despite its growing appeal, solo travel often presents several challenges, including feelings of loneliness, safety concerns, higher travel expenses, and the burden of managing logistics independently. These issues can diminish the overall travel experience, especially for those venturing into unfamiliar regions.

With the rapid advancement of mobile and web-based technologies, innovative digital solutions have been developed to overcome such limitations. Among these, travel buddy finder systems have emerged as an effective and social approach to enhancing the travel experience. These systems enable travelers to find companions with similar destinations, travel dates, or interests, thereby promoting companionship, cultural exchange, and cost-sharing. Furthermore, by fostering mutual support and interaction, such platforms contribute to a safer and more enjoyable travel environment.

In this context, the proposed system titled "Travel Together" introduces a comprehensive travel companion matching platform that integrates multiple smart features into a single application. Unlike traditional platforms that primarily focus on user matching or chat functions, Travel Together employs AI-driven algorithms to recommend compatible travel partners based on interest profiles, destinations, and behavioural data. It also incorporates real-time location tracking, profile verification machanisms, and user feedback systems to enhance trust, safety, and reliability within the community.

This review examines the functionality and limitations of existing travel buddy systems, identifying opportunities for innovation in terms of user experience, safety, and intelligent matchmaking. The ultimate goal of the Travel Together concept is to design a secure, interactive, and user-friendly platform that not only facilitates meaningful travel connections but also ensures an enriching, affordable, and safe journey for all users.

1.2 Aim

The aim of the Travel Together – A Buddy Finder System is to develop an intelligent and secure web-based platform that helps travelers find compatible travel companions based on their destination, travel dates, and interests. The system seeks to enhance the solo travel experience by promoting social connections, ensuring safety through verified profiles, and simplifying trip coordination through communication and itinerary-sharing features.

1.5 Objective

The main objective of the Travel Together project is to design and develop an intelligent and secure Web Platform that connects travelers with similar destinations, interests, and travel periods. The system aims to enhance the solo travel experience through meaningful companionship, cost-sharing, and safety features.

Specific Objectives:

1. To develop a user-friendly web and mobile application that allows travelers to register, create detailed profiles, and specify their travel preferences such as destinations, dates, and interests.
2. To implement an intelligent matching algorithm that recommends suitable travel companions based on user preferences, trip details, and compatibility scores.

Annexure III:

Photographs During Work

Annexure IV:

PO, PSO Mapping Table

Program Outcomes (POs)

PO1: Engineering knowledge: Apply the knowledge of mathematics, science, engineering fundamentals, and an engineering specialization to the solution of complex engineering problems.

PO2: Problem analysis: Identify, formulate, review research literature, and analyze complex engineering problems reaching substantiated conclusions using first principles of mathematics, natural sciences and engineering sciences.

PO3: Design/development of solutions: Design solutions for complex engineering problems and design system components or processes that meet the specified needs with appropriate consideration for the public health and safety, and the cultural, societal, and environmental considerations.

PO4: Conduct investigations of complex problems: Use research-based knowledge and research methods including design of experiments, analysis and interpretation of data, and synthesis of the information to provide valid conclusions.

PO5: Modern tool usage: Create, select, and apply appropriate techniques, resources, and modern engineering and IT tools including prediction and modeling to complex engineering activities with an understanding of the limitations.

PO6: The engineer and society: Apply reasoning informed by the contextual knowledge to assess societal, health, safety, legal and cultural issues and the consequent responsibilities relevant to the professional engineering practice.

PO7: Environment and sustainability: Understand the impact of the professional engineering solutions in societal and environmental contexts, and demonstrate the knowledge of, and need for sustainable development.

PO8: Ethics: Apply ethical principles and commit to professional ethics and responsibilities and norms of the engineering practice.

PO9: Individual and team work: Function effectively as an individual, and as a member or leader in diverse teams, and in multidisciplinary settings.

PO10: Communication: Communicate effectively on complex engineering activities with the engineering community and with society at large, such as, being able to comprehend and write effective reports and design documentation, make effective presentations, and give and receive clear instructions.

PO11: Project management and finance: Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the engineering and management principles and apply these to one's own work, as a member and leader in a team, to manage projects and in multidisciplinary environments.

PO12: Life-long learning: Recognize the need for, and have the preparation and ability to engage in independent and life-long learning in the broadest context of technological change.

Program Specific Outcomes (PSOs)

PSOs Description Attainment Level

PSO1: Demonstrate skills in designing algorithms and implement them in a suitable computational resource.

PSO2: Apply knowledge in fundamental and applied areas as per need of time.

POs/PSOs	PO1	PO2	PO3	PO4	PO5	PO6	PO7	PO8	PO9	PO10	PO11	PO12	PSO1	PSO2
Travel Together	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Name of Students	**Sign**	**Name of Guide & Sign**
Hrutuja Umratkar		Prof. Y. D. Choudhari
Aman Yadav		
Chandan Kumar		
Prakash Wagh		

PROJECT POSTER

K.D.K College of Engineering, Nagpur

Department Of Information Techonlogy

B.TECH - VII Semester

Travel Together - A Web Platform for Solo Travellers

Name of Students: Aman Yadav , Hrutuja Umratkar , Prakash Wagh , Chandan Kumar

Guide: Prof. Y. D. Choudhari

Session: 2025 - 2026

ABSTRACT: In the age of digital connectivity, travellers increasingly seek companions who share similar itineraries, interests, and safety concerns. Buddy finder systems aim to connect travellers based on mutual preferences, enabling shared experiences and reducing the risks of solo travel. This review examines the evolution of travel companion matching platforms, with a focus on the conceptual "Travel Together" system. Existing literature and industry examples are analyzed in terms of matching algorithms, communication features, safety mechanisms, and user adoption. Challenges, limitations, and future directions are discussed, highlighting the potential for AI-driven personalization and blockchain-based identity verification in the travel buddy domain.

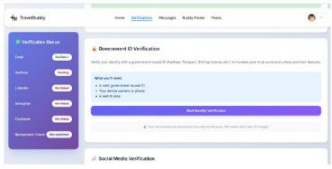
INTRODUCTION :

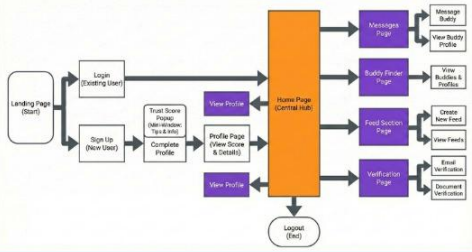
The rapid growth of digital technologies and mobile internet has transformed the travel industry, especially with the rise of solo travel. Travelers increasingly seek platforms that connect them with like-minded companions to improve safety, reduce costs, and enhance travel experiences. However, traditional travel platforms mainly focus on bookings and lack intelligent social connectivity features.

Travel companion systems have emerged to address this gap by matching users based on destinations, dates, interests, and behavior. Early systems used rule-based or content-based approaches, while modern platforms leverage machine learning, collaborative filtering, and context-aware techniques for more personalized recommendations.

Trust and safety are crucial in such platforms, as users interact with strangers. Features like identity verification, reviews, and secure communication significantly influence user engagement. Despite progress, challenges such as cold-start issues, scalability, privacy concerns, and data sparsity remain.

The proposed system, "Travel Together," aims to overcome these limitations by integrating AI-based intelligent matching, strong safety mechanisms, and a user-friendly design to deliver a secure and effective travel companion platform.





CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE:

This section presents the final output of the Travel Together web application. The system offers a functional platform for solo travelers with key interfaces including the Landing Page, Home Page, Verification Center, and Community Feed. The dynamic feed displays user-generated content from MongoDB, The Home Page provides navigation and buddy finder options, and the Verification Center ensures trust athrough identity verification.

The Travel Together – A Buddy Finder System can be enhanced with advanced AI-based recommendations for more accurate travel partner matching. GPS integration can enable real-time location tracking to improve safety and coordination. Developing Android and iOS mobile applications will increase accessibility, while in-app group chat and secure payment features will support seamless communication, expense sharing, and trip management

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2. A. Khan and M. Roy, "Travel Buddy App using KGAT for Personalized Recommendations," SSRN Electronic Journal, vol. 2023. DOI: https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4528342

PROGRAM OUTCOME (PO'S):

- Engineering Knowledge
- Problem Analysis
- Design/Development of Solutions
- Modern Tool Usage
- Individual and Team Work
- 12. Life-Long Learning

POs	PO1	PO2	PO3	PO5	PO9	PO10	PO12
Travel Together	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Name Of Students	Signature
Aman Yadav	
Hrutuja Umratkar	
Prakash Wagh	
Chandan Kumar	

Name & Sign. of the guide:	Signature
Prof. Y. D. Choudhari	